lightweight yet durable construction. Operated via radio signals from the ground, the OQ-2 could be launched by catapult and recovered by parachute, allowing repeated use. Its production of over 15,000 units marked the beginning of UAV industrialization, demonstrating that unmanned systems could be manufactured at scale and operated reliably. The *Radioplane OQ-2* thus stands as a landmark in drone history, bridging early experimental UAVs and the operational aerial platforms that followed.



Figure 2.6 The Radioplane OQ-2 (1939) – the first mass-produced target drone.⏎

2.6.2.5 Ruston Proctor Aerial Target (1917)

The Ruston Proctor Aerial Target (1917) stands as one of the earliest and most influential achievements in the history of unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) development. Built by the Ruston Proctor Aircraft Company in the United Kingdom, under the technical supervision of A. M. Low, this aircraft was designed as a pilotless, radio-controlled platform for defense experimentation during World War I. The project was part of Britain's pioneering efforts to explore the potential of remotely controlled aircraft for military applications, particularly in intercepting and neutralizing enemy zeppelins and aircraft without risking human pilots.